Chapter 10

Managing State in Stimulus Code

As we have been building our sample concert application in this book, we've spent a lot of time worrying about managing state. By *state*, I mean the set of values the front end needs in order to draw the correct information to the screen and properly manage user interaction. In the Hotwire and Stimulus universe, state and data are largely stored on the server, and managed by adjusting the dataset of various DOM elements and using the browser and Stimulus controllers to work with that information. While a Hotwire and Stimulus application may use external objects to manage client-only abstractions, you probably don't need separate objects beyond the DOM just to manage the state of the application.

In this chapter, we'll build out our calendar filter to the schedule page using the DOM to hold our client-side state. We'll also look at how to use the MutationObserver API to detect DOM changes that might indicate client-side state updates. Later, we'll see that a complex React app often does use separate objects to hold state values that Stimulus tries to keep in the DOM.